

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Ambulatory EEG Monitoring

160.22

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

160.22

Manual Section Title

Ambulatory EEG Monitoring

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

06/12/1984

Ending Effective Date of this Version

01/01/2023

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Ambulatory, or 24-hour electroencephalographic (EEG) monitoring is accomplished by a cassette recorder that continuously records brain wave patterns during 24 hours of a patient's routine daily activities and sleep. The monitoring equipment consists of an

electrode set, preamplifiers, and a cassette recorder. The electrodes attach to the scalp, and their leads are connected to a recorder, usually worn on a belt.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Ambulatory EEG monitoring is a diagnostic procedure for patients in whom a seizure diathesis is suspected but not defined by history, physical or resting EEG. Ambulatory EEG can be utilized in the differential diagnosis of syncope and transient ischemic attacks if not elucidated by conventional studies. Ambulatory EEG should always be preceded by a resting EEG.

Ambulatory EEG monitoring is considered an established technique and covered under Medicare for the above purposes.

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 11824 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

[TN 11865 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Ambulatory EEG Monitoring - RETIRED	3	04/10/2023 - N/A	View
Ambulatory EEG Monitoring - Retired	2	01/01/2023 - 04/10/2023	View
Ambulatory EEG Monitoring	1	06/12/1984 - 01/01/2023	You are here